

Donghao Wu

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, George Washington University Research Interest: Applied Econometrics, Consumer Behavior, Public Policy	Anticipated: December 2026
Master of Science in Economics, Georgetown University Relevant Coursework: Data Analysis, Econometrics, and Financial Econometrics	August 2018 – May 2020
Bachelor of Arts in Economics, University of Maryland, College Park	August 2014 – May 2018

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Intelliimpact, Remote <i>Data Science Intern</i> - Supported U.S. electric utility clients in solving distribution network challenges through predictive analytics and data-driven decision support. - Built end-to-end analytics pipelines by integrating AMI time-series, weather, and grid connectivity data, engineering features from load patterns, seasonality, and lagged demand. - Developed and evaluated Decision Tree, Random Forest, and Gradient Boosting models for load forecasting and outage risk prediction, improving forecasting accuracy by approximately 10–20%. - Applied K-means, DBSCAN, and distance-based methods to detect abnormal consumption patterns, supporting operational monitoring through Tableau dashboards.	February 2026 – April 2026
Census Research Data Center, Washington, D.C. <i>Research Assistant for Prof. Rachel Meltzer (Harvard University) and Prof. Leah Brooks (GWU)</i> - Supported an urban economics research project in the Federal Statistical Research Data Center using restricted establishment-level microdata to study whether retail-space supply aligned with demand, and whether mismatch contributed to vacancy across five major U.S. cities. - Cleaned, standardized, and integrated large-scale CoStar, InfoUSA, and Census RDC data in R across location, time, leasing, and establishment-level dimensions to build analysis-ready datasets. - Conducted cross-city analyses of leasing activity, rents, and retail-space utilization, contributing to an urban economics research project on retail-space mismatch and commercial vacancy.	May 2023 – August 2023
Public Spend Forum, Washington, D.C. <i>Research Analyst Intern</i> - Supported a government-procurement startup in improving supplier coverage, data quality, and matching efficiency between public-sector demand and SME supply. - Analyzed platform data, FPDS, USAspending, and Crunchbase, and designed SME surveys to identify barriers to entry in government contracting and inform onboarding strategy. - Standardized procurement data by classifying 100+ emerging technology categories and structuring keywords, synonyms, and PSC codes to improve taxonomy consistency and search usability. - Developed Tableau dashboards and expanded a supplier database by onboarding over 43,000 technology-focused SMEs, improving supplier discovery and supporting evidence-based business decisions.	February 2019 – May 2020

RESEARCH PAPERS

Spatial Spending Shifts during COVID-19: Evidence from Transaction Data in U.S. Cities - Analyzed large-scale transaction data using difference-in-differences methods to quantify how COVID-19 led remote work reshaped consumer spending across metropolitan areas. - Identified persistent geographic shifts in spending and heterogeneous effects across income groups and cities.
Temporary Tax Relief and Consumer Demand: Evidence from U.S. Sales Tax Holidays - Evaluated the impact of temporary sales tax holidays on consumer spending using high-frequency transaction data. - Found substantial geographic heterogeneity driven by local market conditions and cross-border shopping.
Monetary Policy Transmission to Consumption: Evidence from Transaction-Level Data Examined dynamic consumer spending responses to monetary policy surprises using transaction-level data and local projection methods.

SKILLS

Programming: Python (Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn), MySQL, R, Stata | **Statistical & Econometric Methods:** A/B Testing, Difference-in-Differences, Event Study, Instrumental Variables, Local Projections, Propensity Score Matching | **Visualization:** Tableau | **Machine Learning:** Decision Trees, Gradient Boosting, K-means, Random Forest